

Metadata

- *Coder ID:*
- *PL ID:*
- *Description type (generic, exemplar or mixed):*

Tradition

Optional plain text description of the tradition's history.

Variant

Optional plain text description of the variant's history.

Predecessor traditions / variants

If known, provide the traditions / variant that are regarded as the formal predecessors of the coded tradition / variant.

Successor traditions / variants

If known, provide the traditions / variant that are regarded as the formal successors of the coded tradition / variant.

Template version

For bookkeeping purposes. Please do not alter.

v 6.0

Social level

This block describes the social embedding of a poetic tradition as well as its modes of production and reception.

Sources

Plain text

To have the literature cited backed up within the coding sheet, this feature provides a plain text field to input the sources used.

Enter all sources used for answering the questionnaire in a .bib file BibTeX format, each entry separated by a blank line.

- For citations within this documentation file or the data sheet use the unique citekeys.
- For citing convention please confer literature page

Documentation:

SL011: What continent is the *PL-entity* found on?

Categorical (1: Africa, 2: North America, 3: South America, 4: Asia, 5: Europe, 6: Oceania)

This feature asks about the area of origin or primary distribution of the poetic *PL-entity* being described. While the indicated continent usually coincides with the location of the language in which a *PL-entity* is *composed*, this need not be the case. Expatriate *PL-entities* or *PL-entities* which use foreign languages are, in fact, considered quite noteworthy.

Delimiting factors are subject to definition, which for purposes of this project are defined as follows: North and South America are separated by the Isthmus of Panama; Asia and Africa are separated by the Isthmus of Suez; Europe and Asia are separated by the Ural river, Ural mountains, and the Turkish Straits. These definitions are not exhaustive, yet should suffice for a rough grouping.

In case of the Europe/Asia boundary, the definitions are cultural and historic - and have been subject to change over the centuries. They are not universally agreed upon to this day. When coding this feature, attention should be paid to the cultural background, which should guide classification.

Documentation:

SL021: Beginning of era

Date

Oldest known or estimated composition which can be attributed to the described *PL-entity*.

Documentation:

SL022: End of era

Date

The date when the last known composition which can be attributed to the described *PL-entity* was created.

- Code "?" if no indication of age can be found.

Documentation:

SL031: Context of the *PL-entity*

Religious and social context, artificiality, narrative, and historical topics of the *PL-entity*

Tag set (see *values_v6 document*)

enter **all** tags which best describe the typical use and thematic content of the *PL-entity*:

- religious topics or used in a religious context,
- topics used in a mundane social context,
- being ostentatiously *artistic* in the sense that its main purpose is to be appreciated by listeners for its

artistic beauty, well-formedness *eo ipso* and the erudition of the poet,

- or serves to provide a framework within which *stories* can be told,
- or serves to provide a framework within which events or the lives of *historically relevant* protagonists (or antagonists) can to be re-told,

Separate multiple tags with semicolon ;.

Refer to the wiki (Values V6) for the table of tags.

Documentation:

SL040: Does the *PL-entity* combine poetic form and prose?

Boolean

This feature asks about the integration of prose sections in the poetic form, or the reverse.

- If the *PL-entity* allows interspersing passages of prose, or is used as an accompaniment to *other modalities*, code **1**
- This feature is not regarded as hierarchically dependent of the SL03x block. **NA** is not a possible value here.

Documentation:

SL050 What is the mode of performance?

Categorical (*Declamation; Lecturing; Reading; Multimodal*)

This feature captures the mode in which the compositions belonging to the described *PL-entity* are typically performed. The possible values are:

- **Multimodal:** A *PL-entity* is to be performed in combination with some or several performing art form(s) such as, music, dance or theater or any kind of combination thereof.
- **Declamation:** Any *recited* performance to an audience which is independent of the presence of a physical representation of the text or any other art forms.
- **Lecturing:** Any performance which requires that the *PL-entity* is read from a textual representation.
- **Reading:** A *PL-entity* is meant to be read silently only. Any kind of performing it would seem odd or inappropriate.

Documentation:

SL051: Is the *PL-entity* performed chanting or singing?

Ternary

As *chanting* or *singing* we regard any rhythmical use of the voice which goes beyond theatrical enunciation for dramatic or narrative purposes. I.e. is there a layer of musical structure which is relevant for performance.

Thus not only singing in a strictly musical sense, but also interspersed sections of rhythmic humming between the lines or other non-verbal chanting are encoded as **1** here.

- If compositions may be chanted/sung, but may also be performed speaking code: **0**
- If compositions are obligatorily chanted/sung, code: **1**.
- If compositions are only spoken and never chanted/sung code: **2**
- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050 and thus is never performed, this feature inherits: **NA**
- If there is insufficient information on performance habits code: **?**

Documentation:

SL052 How many individuals can maximally perform the *PL-entity*?

Ordinal (*one, two, many*)

Encodes how many performers can maximally jointly perform a single *PL-entity*. Always pick the highest possible value. E.g. If a poem may be performed as a duet or a solo, but never by more people we encode **two**.

Potential musicians are not taken into account unless they are both playing instruments and participating in reading/performing the verbal part of the performance (requires the value **both** or **performer** in SL054).

- If the *PL-entity* is performed by exactly one person, code: **one**
- If the *PL-entity* is performed by maximally two performers, code: **two**
- If the *PL-entity* can be performed by three or more performers, code: **many**
- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050 and thus is never performed, code: **NA**
- If there is insufficient information on performance habits code: **?**

Documentation:

SL053: Is the *PL-entity* performed with instrumental musical accompaniment?

Ternary

We encode **1** only if musical *instruments* of any kind are used for accompaniment.

If human voice is involved, it is encoded as a **1** in SL051.

- If musical accompaniment is allowed but not a necessary feature of a valid performance code: **0**
- If musical accompaniment is a necessary feature of a valid performance code: **1**
- If musical accompaniment is forbidden as part of the performance code: **2**
- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050) this feature inherits: **NA**

Documentation:

SL054: Who accompanies the performance of the *PL-entity* musically?

Categorical (performer; other; both)

- If the *performers* accompany themselves without any additional musicians being allowed, code: **performer**
- If the musical accompaniment is performed by one or more dedicated musicians code: **other**.
- If the *performers* accompany themselves, but may or must be accompanied by dedicated musicians as well code: **both**
- If there is no musical accompaniment, or the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050) this feature inherits: **NA**
- If there is insufficient information on performance habits code: **?**

Documentation:

SL060: Are there any restrictions regarding the performance of the *PL-entity*?

Boolean

Are there **any** restrictions with respect to how, when, by whom or for whom the *PL-entity* may be performed?

If performances co-occur with *other modalities* (coded as **Multimodal** in SL050), any restrictions regarding specifically the musicians, dancers, actors, etc. are ignored here and in the entire SL06x block.

- If no restrictions apply code: **0**
- If performance restrictions apply code: **1**
- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050) this feature inherits: **NA**
- If no description of the context of performances could be found encode this and all following SL06x features as: **?**

Documentation:

SL061 Is performance restricted to defined occasions?

Boolean

We define a restriction to a *performance occasion* as one of the following:

- i. A severe spatial restriction regarding the places where a *PL-entity* must or must not be performed. Examples are temples, theaters, hidden gathering spaces and the like.
- ii. The *PL-entity* is intrinsically linked to a defined ritual or calendric time-span. Examples can be annual tribal gatherings or war chants.

iii. Restrictions should be explicit taboos rooted in culture or religion. A restriction that is a result of an economic or physical inability to attend performances is of no relevance here.

- If no restrictions apply code: **0**
- If performance restrictions apply code: **1**
- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050) this feature inherits: **NA**
- If no description of occasion restrictions could be found, encode this feature as: **?**

Documentation:

SL062 Describe the nature of the occasion-restrictions.

Plain text

Briefly define the *performance occasions* to which performances are limited and add further literature references where possible.

- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050) this feature inherits: **NA**
- If no restrictions apply code: **NA**, but you may optionally leave a remark about *performace occasions* in the documentation file.
- If the description is lacking, code **?**

Documentation:

SL063: Are there restrictions on the audience or the readership who is allowed to attend a performance or have access to the text?

Boolean

Restrictions should be explicit taboos rooted in culture or religion. A restriction that is a result of an economic or physical inability to attend performances is of no relevance here.

- If performances may only be witnessed by a specific group or access to the text is restricted code **1**
- If performances may be witnessed by everyone without restrictions or the access to the text is not restricted code **0**
- If the description is lacking, code **?**

Documentation:

SL064: Describe the nature of the restrictions on the audience or readership.

Plain text

Briefly describe to which audiences or readerships access to performances or texts is limited and why. Add further literature references where possible.

- If no restrictions apply code: **NA**

- If the description is lacking, code ?

Documentation:

SL065 Are there restrictions on who may perform a *PL-entity*?

Boolean

Restrictions should be explicit taboos rooted in culture or religion. A restriction that is a result of an economic or physical inability to attend performances is of no relevance here.

- If no restrictions apply, code: **0**
- If performance restrictions apply, code: **1**
- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050) this feature inherits: **NA**
- If no description of the context of performances could be found, code: ?

Documentation:

SL066: Describe the restrictions on potential performers.

Plain text

Briefly describe to whom the right to perform compositions is limited and why. Add further literature references where possible.

- If the *PL-entity* only exists in written form (coded as **Reading** in SL050) this feature inherits: **NA**
- If no restrictions apply code: **NA**
- If the description is lacking, code ?

Documentation:

SL070: Who is perceived as the author to the *PL-entity*?

Categorical (*known; contested; common*)

Authorship is to be reported the way a culture describes it. If a *PL-entity* is said to have been written down by a prophet, name the prophet not the deity. If authorship is attributed to a historical figure whose existence is dubious or who could not very likely have been the sole author, we still report the emic perspective of the culture as a single known author.

- If there is a single attested author for all compositions of the *PL-entity*, such as the writer of a national epic, code: **known**
- If the *PL-entity* is a common knowledge to which multiple authors with sufficient skill and status can or could contribute code: **common**
- If the question of authorship is highly contested within the culture itself, code **contested**.
- If the description is lacking, code: ?

Documentation:

SL071: Describe the author as emically known.

Plain text

Minimally report the name of the author, if known. If possible leave a remark about the historical status (mythical, real, etc.) of dubious authors.

- If SL070 has been coded as known, report details on the author.
- If SL070 has been coded as **contested**, describe the nature of doubt in the documentation file.
- If SL070 has been coded as common describe what is seen as a status and skill which makes an author.
- If SL070 has been coded as **?**, this feature inherits **?**.

Documentation:

SL072: Is there a scholarly discussion about the nature of the author(s)?

Plain text

Documentation:

Poetic rules level

Here we ask about the levels of *poetic rules* which prescribe what a well-formed *composition* of the *PL-entity* described looks like, i.e. this level describes the *poetic system*.

Each *PL-entity* is described in a decompositional way by identifying its building blocks, their units and rules of composition in a top-down manner. This is guided by the assumption that poems are thus built incrementally from small units which grow larger as a poem is composed.

Sources

Plain text

To have the literature cited backed up within the coding sheet, this feature provides a plain text field to input the sources used.

Enter all sources used for answering the questionnaire in the project's shared Zotero Library. Once you did so, BibTeX-export the references in the present document ([BibTeX format](#)) . Each entry will be separated by a blank line.

- For citations within this documentation file or the data sheet use the unique citekeys (automatically generated by Bib-TeX-exporting the references).

Documentation:

Structure of the composition

This section will provide a verbose overview of the composition and its poetic level. Here you will provide all the information (plain text accompanied by citations or screen shots) about the composition. The main goal here is to transparently present the base used for the re-construction of the poetic levels that you will describe further below.

Note that it is **really** important to write everything down in great details, so that in a few months, we still will be able to follow through your reasoning path.

Describe the structure of the composition

We start from the assumption that poems are built incrementally from small units which grow larger as a poem is composed.

Based on the available descriptions, how many ordered levels can be assumed? Provide an ordered list.

If during analysis you discover that the initially assumed levels need to be reconsidered or reordered, do so.

Ordered list for the poetic levels

Example:

Homeric epic consists of (in descending order):

- 5 complete composition
- 4 Odyssey, Ilias
- 3 books
- 2 hexameter
- 1 feet and their linguistic properties (quantities: morae)

Documentation

How did you get to the levels listed above? What information do you base your argumentation on?

Please, be as extensive and verbose as necessary.

Overview of the poetic levels

The next step is to provide a more detailed overview of the poetic levels listed above. In the following table, fill in the levels mentioned above and provide a short description (below an example from Middle Breton. The third column 'some shapes' refers to examples. Not that you can either provide one by level or an entire composition exhibiting clearly all the levels after the table.

level	description	some shapes
L1	units of variable syllable size, min between 3 (?) and 11 (?) syllables; the right edge is special because final syllables of these units participate in rhyme at L2 (resumption from preceding end rhyme; internal rhymes); internal rhyme in L1 is optional (i.e. ornamental)	6σ, optional rhyme in <i>et</i> , for example: gourchemē net net voe

level	description	some shapes
L2	one or two L1 units; total syllable number varies: largest 22, smallest 4, there is no variation here; units defined by syllable numbers are not mutually substitutable = types; L2 structures that consist of two L1 contain an additional structural feature, a caesura: L1 L1; the ultimate syllable of first L1 and the (ante)penultimate of 2nd L1 form a rhyming pair	any "line" in MB poetry
L3	combinations of L2 units ...	"stanzas"
...	...	

Structure of the poetic levels

In this section we will describe the structure of each level identified above. Since every PL presents a different structure, the template is hold very broad. However, each level will be describe based properties and constraints. The properties are repeated below. Their exact description is illustrated in detail in the document 'Concepts' that you'll find on the drive, in the folder 'Information'.

Please be aware that some of the linguistic properties descriptions are very specific and have to be followed as such.

The possible properties for poetic rules are:

- Prosodic prominence
- Grammatical quantity
- Syllables
- Phonetic property
- Tone/Phonation property
- Word property
- Syntactic property
- Semantic property
- Graphematic property
- Morphology
- Narrative Structure
- Intonation Phrase
- Phonetic property 2
- Semantic property 2
- Performance
- Pragmatics
- Other property 3, 4, 5, 6 etc.

For the constraints use the decision tree located in the 'Concept' document in the shared drive in the folder 'Information'.

Poetic rules level 1

L1 relies on X properties:

- Prop X
- Prop Y
- ...

Documentation

Please illustrate your decision path, list all the reasons why you selected a specific linguistic property, and add documentation. Also add examples for illustration.

Range

In the 'Range' section we define the complexity and size of the level currently under description. 'Complexity' refers to the number of different forms of a linguistic property that play a role in the arrangement within a Lx. Please register the highest and the lowest number of forms of a particular property as minimally complex (MinC) and maximally complex (MaxC). For both MaxC and MinC, please register the largest and smallest size (sMaxC / lMaxC; sMinC / lMinC) of occurrences of the forms required.

- maximal complexity: X forms Prop X, X forms Prop Y
 - largest maximally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)
 - smallest maximally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)
- minimal complexity: X forms Prop X, X forms Prop Y
 - largest minimally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)
 - smallest minimally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)

Documentation

Please illustrate your decision path, list all your reflection steps, and add documentation. Also add examples for illustration.

Constraints

Please specify the constraints that apply to the arrangement of occurrences of property forms: count; ordering; covariation; position. Select all constraints that apply. Note that constraints may be different for MaxC and MinC.

- Prop X:
- Prop Y:
- ...

Tags

Please register the emic wording as provided in the description to describe the pattern characterised by this property and its constraint(s). Separate multiple tags by ; . Note that constraints may be different for MaxC and MinC.

Documentation

Please illustrate your decision path, describe all the steps of your analysis, and add documentation. Also add examples for illustration.

- Pop X:
- Prop Y:
- ...

Summary

Report the numbers calculated above in the 'Range' section in the following tables. Please fill out one table per property, name it after the property. In each cell you'll write down the number of types, the number of occurrences, the constraint(s) and the tag.

L1: Property	IMaxC	sMaxC	IMinC	sMinC
forms				
occurrences				
constraints				
tags				

L1: Property	IMaxC	sMaxC	IMinC	sMinC
forms				
occurrences				
constraints				
tags				

Poetic rules level 2

L2 relies on X properties:

- Prop X
- Prop Y
- ...

Documentation

Please illustrate your decision path, list all the reasons why you selected a specific linguistic property, and add documentation. Also add examples for illustration.

Range

In the 'Range' section we define the complexity and size of the level currently under description. 'Complexity' refers to the number of different forms of a linguistic property that play a role in the arrangement within a Lx. Please register the highest and the lowest number of forms of a particular property as minimally complex (MinC) and maximally complex (MaxC). For both MaxC and MinC, please register the largest and smallest size (sMaxC / IMaxC; sMinC / IMinC) of occurrences of the forms required.

- maximal complexity: X forms Prop X, X forms Prop Y
 - largest maximally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)
 - smallest maximally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)
- minimal complexity: X forms Prop X, X forms Prop Y
 - largest minimally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)
 - smallest minimally complex: x occurrences (describe the relevant occurrences of the required forms of each property)

Documentation

Please illustrate your decision path, list all your reflection steps, and add documentation. Also add examples for illustration.

Constraints

Please specify the constraints that apply to the arrangement of occurrences of property forms: count; ordering; covariation; position. Select all constraints that apply. Note that constraints may be different for MaxC and MinC.

- Prop X:
- Prop Y:
- ...

Tags

Please register the emic wording as provided in the description to describe the pattern characterised by this property and its constraint(s). Separate multiple tags by ; . Note that constraints may be different for MaxC and MinC.

Documentation

Please illustrate your decision path, describe all the steps of your analysis, and add documentation. Also add examples for illustration.

- Pop X:
- Prop Y:
- ...

Summary

Report the numbers calculated above in the 'Range' section in the following tables. Please fill out one table per property, name it after the property. In each cell you'll write down the number of types, the number of occurrences, the constraint(s) and the tag.

L2: Property	IMaxC	sMaxC	IMinC	sMinC
forms				
occurrences				
constraints				
tags				

L2: Property	IMaxC	sMaxC	IMinC	sMinC
forms				
occurrences				
constraints				
tags				

Inherited

Shortly explain the constitution of the inherited features.

L2	IMaxC	sMaxC	IMinC	sMinC
Lx-1 units				
Lx-1 types				
constraints				

Poetic rules level 3, 4, 5 ... ADD LEVELS AS REQUIRED

Add as many levels as required and follow the structure for Level 2 and adapt.

Stylistic level

Here we describe ornamental arrangement of poetic units. *Ornamental* properties are descriptively optional, i.e. cannot be identified as mandatory. We assume that *ornamental* properties are emically correlated with specific aesthetic values. Like mandatory rules (*arrangement constraints*) we assess the ornamental aspect independently for each LX. Likewise, the basis for encoding are the *linguistic properties* which are influenced by such preferences. We distinguish two ways in which ornamental properties can occur.

- An ornamental preference proper expresses a *composer's* desire to include units containing a specific *linguistic property*, or a combination of several properties.
 - An ornamental avoidance reflects observable, but not explicitly forbidden, use or appearance of a *linguistic property* within an *LX-unit*.
-

Stylistic devices on level 1

Is Prosodic Prominence used in an ornamental fashion in L1?

Categorical (*irrelevant; ornamental; avoidance; N/A*)

Can the ornamental relevance of Prosodic Prominence combine with other properties?

Tag set (*None; accent; length; syllable; phonetics; word; prosody; syntax; semantics; morphology; grapheme; other*)

Provide tags which describe the stylistic usage.

Tag set

Documentation

Provide a verbose description of your analysis steps and the associated documentation.

Is Property XX (add properties as required) used in an ornamental fashion in L1?

Categorical(*irrelevant; ornamental; avoidance; N/A*)

Can the ornamental relevance of Grammatical Quantity combine with other properties?

Tag set (*None; accent; length; syllable; phonetics; word; prosody; syntax; semantics; morphology; grapheme; other*)

Provide tags which describe the stylistic usage.

Tag set

Stylistic devices on level 2, 3, 4, ...: ADD LEVELS AS REQUIRED

Further information

Plain text

Describe anything that you consider important beyond what you have described above.
